



ShabbaTTogether

ShabbaTTogether@Home Inclusive @Home Pre-Shabbat Challah Bake

Goal:

Make challah together to highlight inclusion

Target Audience:

Women and Families

Time:

Approximately 1-2 hours

Medium:

@Home or Facilitated Program. Virtual or In-person.

Note to Facilitator:

For virtual events, email Challah recipe, ingredients, and kitchen tools needed in advance.

Note to Families @Home:

Challah is a symbolic food that we enjoy at our Shabbat table generation after generation. It reminds us of our faith that G-d provides us with all our needs, just as He provided us with the Manna from heaven while we traveled in the desert as a new nation thousands of years ago.

While preparing Challah we gather our family, work the dough, and wait for it to rise. It's aroma spreads through our home while baking, and gathers us at the Shabbat table with family and friends to connect, share and learn.

This Shabbat, enjoy this wonderful opportunity to create memories and tradition, while highlighting that each person is an integral part of the whole.

Preparation:

Choose some or all of these resources below for your @Home Challah Bake:

1. [Challah card](#)
2. [Challah Recipe](#)
 - a. [Gluten Free Challah](#)
3. **Discussion ideas**
4. **Alternative challah designs**

1. Challah Card:

[Click here to download](#) and print challah cards to give out with your challahs to friends and family.

2. Challah Recipes:

- a. [Regular Challah](#)
- b. [Gluten Free Challah](#)

3. Discussion ideas:

a. Introduction:

- Today we are going to make our challah look different than usual with different toppings and different shapes. We are also going to make 4 challahs each, 2 to keep, and 2 to give away.

b. Questions/Conversation Starters:

- How many strands of Challah do you use to braid? One, two, six?
- What toppings do you usually use?
- Do all our challahs look the same?
- How are they different? (toppings, shapes, color?)
- How are they similar? (ingredients/insides, shape, color, smell, taste, purpose)
- Do we all look the same?
 - Take time to compare how we all look different and all have similarities.

c. Inclusive Discussion points:

- While baking with your family or after you have made your challahs, discuss how and why the challah making was different. Here are some points to consider:

- G-d made each of us different and unique. Like each strand of the challah dough we are each unique and necessary to create the full picture. We are intertwined with our nation and need each of us to create the whole.
- We are just the way we are supposed to be! Each of the challahs are different too, but only on the outside. On the inside they are the same, like the Jewish people that share a soul with a G-dly spark.
- Even though there can be many types of challah, what do we call all of them? Challah. Even though we are all different, what do we call all of us? People, Am Yisrael.
- This week we had fun making challah not just for ourselves, but also to share with someone else. This is part of sending the message, 'I care about you' and is at the core of our Jewish heritage - the importance of Ahavat Yisrael, our obligation to love and support a fellow Jew in the way that *they* want to be supported.

5. Alternative Challah Designs

- People Challah** - Roll a small ball for a head, and roll logs to create a stick person challah. Use raisins or chocolate chips for eyes, nose and mouth. Children can make them small enough to make two to fit in a 9x13 pan. The two people can hold hands.
- Round Challah** - Roll a thick log and pinch edges together to create a circular challah to highlight how we are all connected and have something to give and something to receive from all people we meet. Or for a fancier version, braid a challah and stretch it out into a long rope then pinch edges for a braided round challah.
- Challah Painting** - Upgrade your toppings with edible paint! Use food coloring gel and small paint brushes to create a work of art.
- Toppings** - Beyond poppy seed and sesame seed, there is a world of toppings! Get creative! Here is a starter list of ideas: Trader Joe's Everything But the Bagel spice, cinnamon, chopped dried garlic or onion, sliced olives, sprinkles, edible small gold balls or hearts, and chopped fresh parsley. Anything edible and small can work!